Educational Ludo

System Report – Iteration 1

Team Sharks

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Software Engineering and Software Quality Assurance in Information Systems

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https://github.com/shafeekseef81-svg/Sharks

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1. About this iteration

Iteration 1 delivers a playable basic Ludo game on the **Easy** level, from the Main Menu to the results screen (SDP 5.2.1, user stories US-1.1 to US-1.5). The application is a Java Swing desktop program built with the MVC architecture required by the course: the packages are `Model`, `View` and `Controller`.

What is in Iteration 1:

- Main Menu, New Game setup with full input validation, the Easy board, turns with the Regular die, legal-move highlighting, square-by-square movement, capture, protected squares, the home path and exact finish, the Rule of 6, the finishing order and ranking, the game clock and the results screen.

What comes in later iterations (by the SDP plan):

- Iteration 2: Medium and Hard boards, special dice (Boost, UltraBoost), Double Blocks, question and surprise squares.
- Iteration 3: game history saved to the course CSV file, administrator login and question management.

2. How to run the system

2.1 Requirements

- Java 17 or later (JRE to run, JDK to build). Tested with Java 23 on Windows 11.
- No internet connection and no installation are needed.

2.2 Running the submitted JAR

The submitted ZIP contains the folder `Iteration1` with the runnable `EducationalLudo.jar`.

System	How to start
Windows	Double-click `run.bat` in the `Iteration1` folder, or run `java -jar EducationalLudo.jar` from inside that folder.
macOS / Linux	Run `./run.sh` in the `Iteration1` folder, or `java -jar EducationalLudo.jar`.

Important (Windows): if the full path of the folder contains Hebrew letters, `java -jar "C:\...\<Hebrew folder>\EducationalLudo.jar"` can fail with "Unable to access jarfile". `run.bat` avoids this because it changes to its own folder first, so please start the game with `run.bat`.

2.3 Building from source and running the tests

Action	Windows	macOS / Linux / Git Bash
Build the JAR	`build.bat`	`./build.sh`
Build and run all tests	`test.bat`	`./test.sh`
Start the game	`run.bat`	`./run.sh`

The tests use JUnit 5 through `lib/junit-platform-console-standalone-1.10.2.jar`, which is included in the folder; it is used only for the tests and is not packed into the game JAR.

3. Inputs

All input is entered on the **New Game** screen. The game itself is played only with mouse clicks (Roll Dice, then a highlighted piece).

Input	Allowed values	What happens with a wrong value
Number of players	2, 3 or 4	Cannot be wrong: chosen with buttons.
Difficulty	Easy (Medium and Hard are shown with an "Iteration 2" tag and cannot be selected)	Cannot be wrong: only Easy can be chosen.
Player name	1–12 characters; spaces and invisible characters at the ends are removed; must be unique (not case-sensitive); any language, including Hebrew	The field is marked in red with a message: "Enter a name (1-12 characters)." or "Player N already uses this name."
Player colour	Red, Green, Yellow, Blue; each colour once	A colour already taken by another player is shown crossed out and cannot be chosen.

While any field is invalid, pressing **Start Game** does not start the game; a line at the bottom says how many fields must be fixed. The settings cannot change once the game has started.

4. What the player can do

The screenshots below were taken from the real application (the integrated Iteration 1 build) at 1280×720.

4.1 Main Menu

The player can start a new game or exit. Game History and Question Management are marked "Soon"; clicking them shows a message that they are part of Iteration 3.



Figure 1 – Main Menu

4.2 Setting up a game

The player chooses the number of players and the difficulty, then enters a name and picks a colour for each player. The order of the list is the turn order.

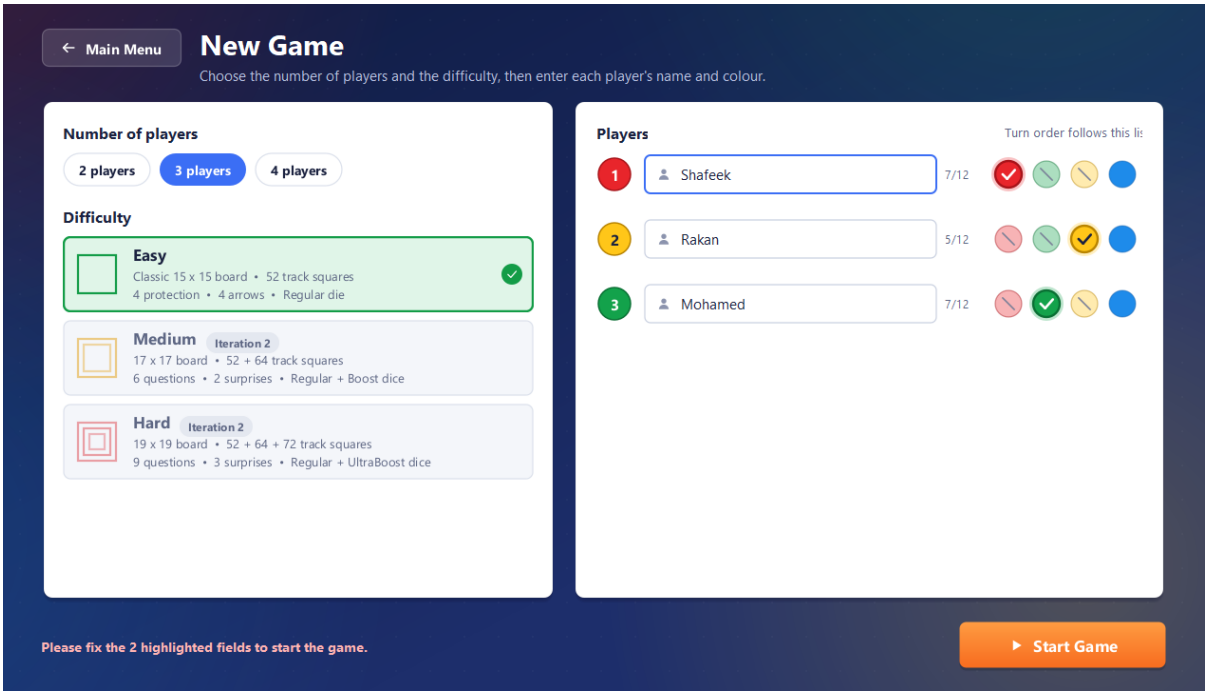


Figure 2 – New Game screen, filled in correctly for three players

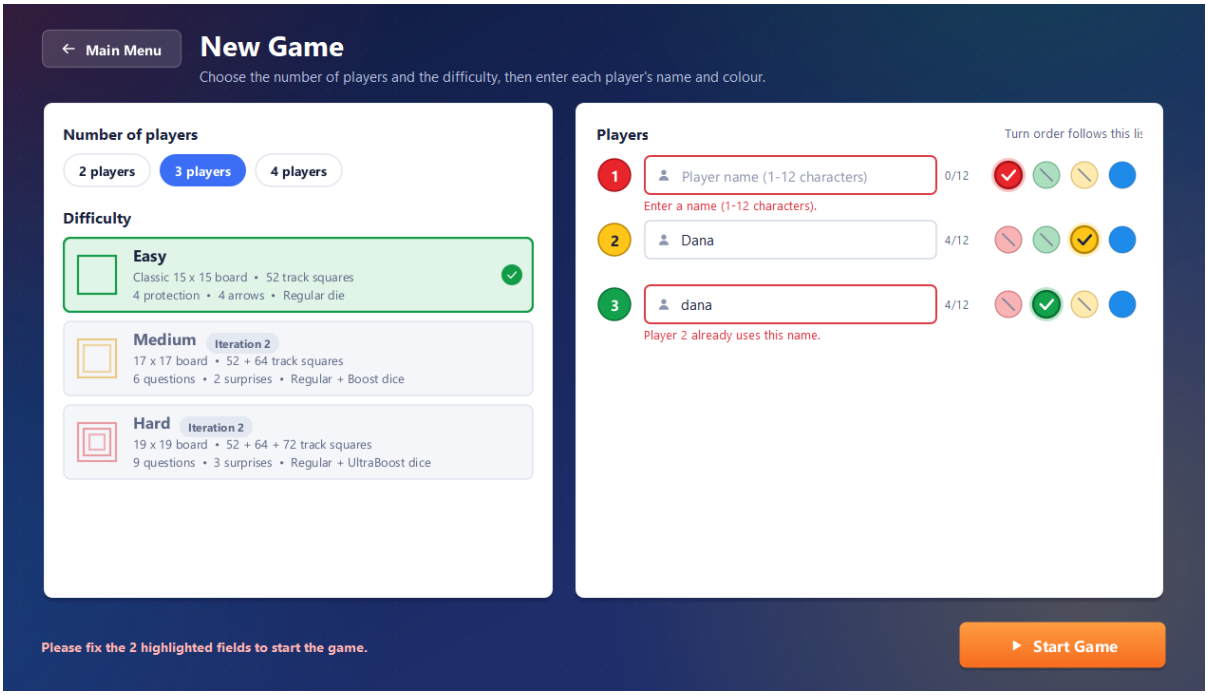


Figure 3 – Validation: an empty name and a duplicate name ("Dana" / "dana") are marked

4.3 Playing

The board shows each player's castle (home base) with four pieces, the shared track, the coloured home paths and the special squares: start squares (#), protection squares (star) and arrows where a piece turns into its home path. The left panel shows the level, the game clock, the players with the number of finished pieces, and the board legend. The right panel shows whose turn it is, the die and a message that tells the player what to do.

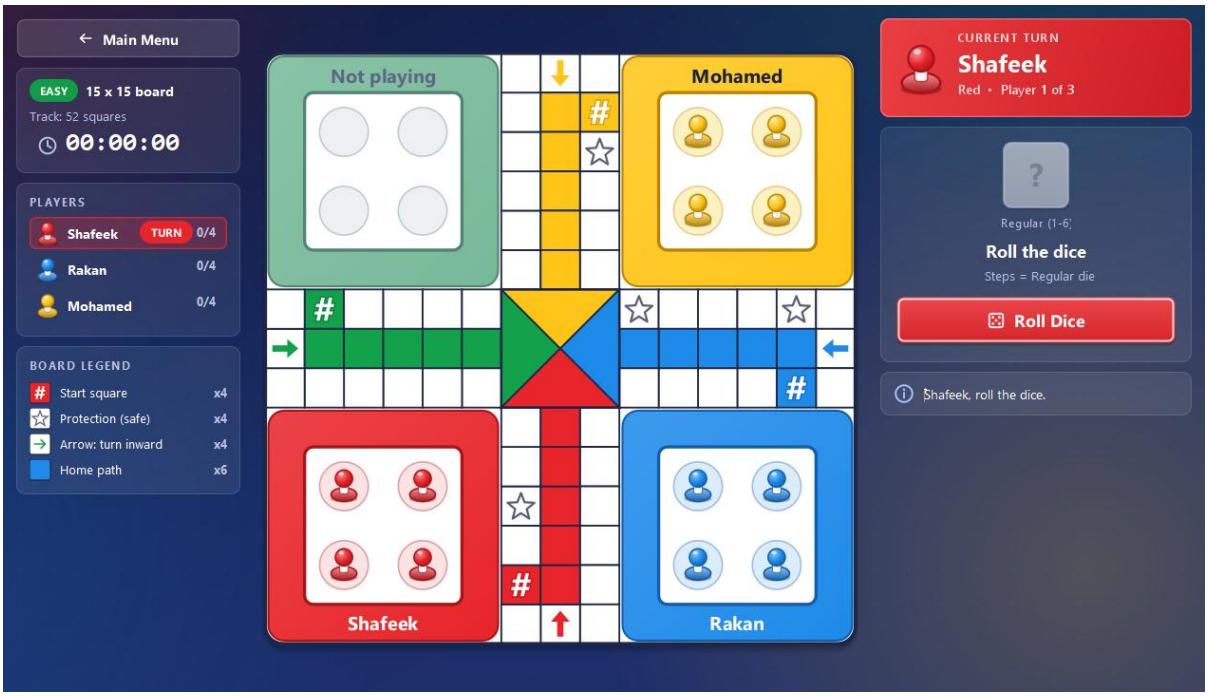


Figure 4 – A new three-player Easy game; the first player is to roll

The active player presses **Roll Dice**. Every piece that may legally move glows; the player clicks one of them. With a 6, a piece can leave the castle to its start square.



Figure 5 – Shafeek rolled a 6: the four castle pieces are highlighted

The piece moves square by square. Because the roll was a 6, the same player rolls again.



Figure 6 – The red piece is on its start square and Shafeek rolls again

Main Menu during a game asks for confirmation, because a game that is left is not saved.

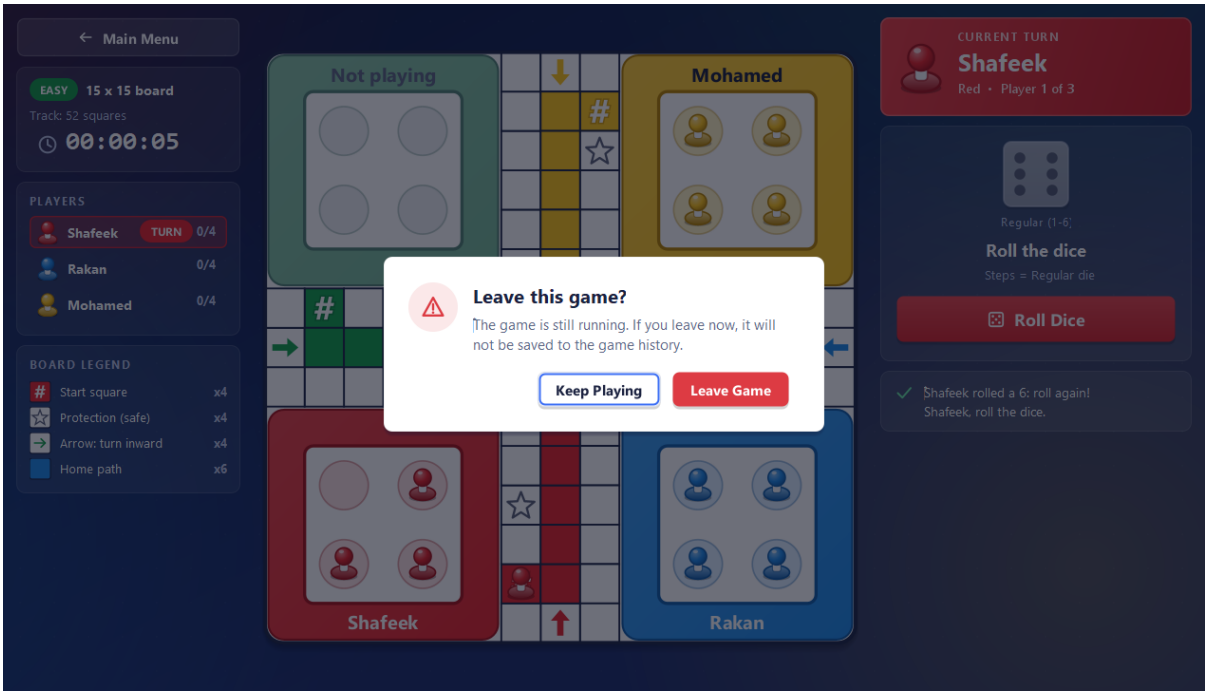


Figure 7 – Leaving a running game needs confirmation

4.4 End of the game

A player who brings all four pieces to the finish leaves the turn order. The game ends when only one player is left; the results screen shows the ranking, the difficulty and the game duration (HH:MM:SS). From here the player can play again with the same settings or go back to the Main Menu.

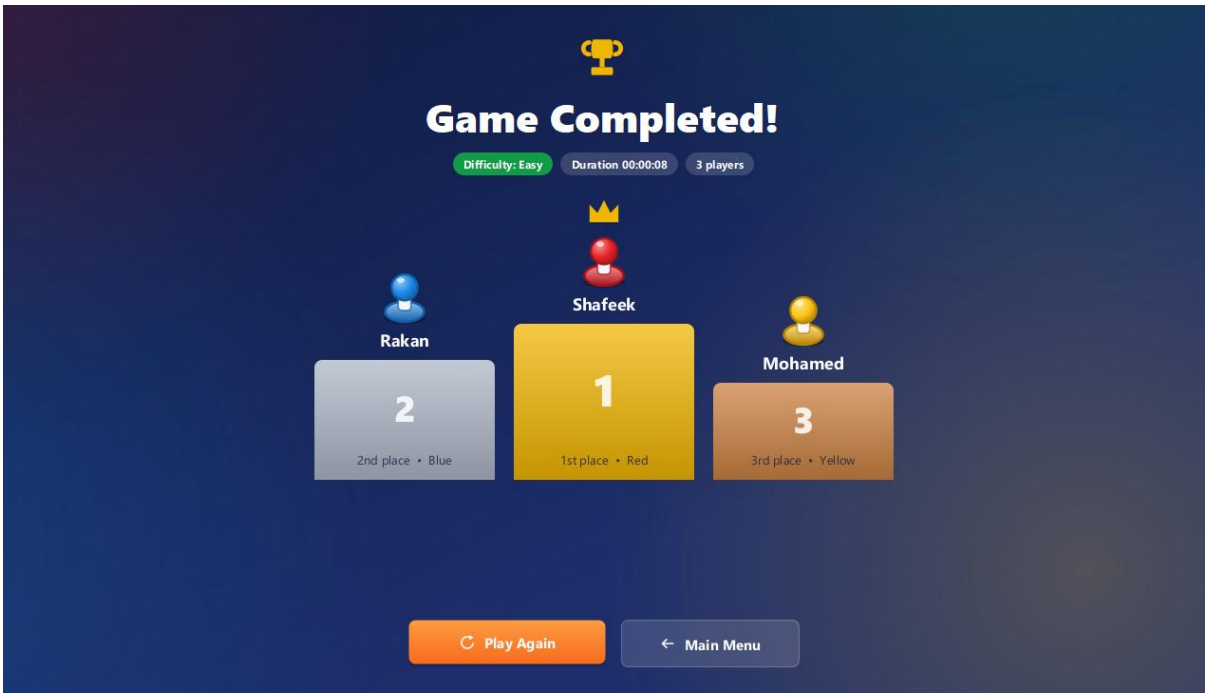


Figure 8 – Results screen (this game was played automatically by a test driver, so its duration is only a few seconds)

5. Expected results in different scenarios

#	Scenario	Expected result
1	Start a game with 2–4 valid, unique names and colours	The board opens; the first player in the list has the turn; the clock starts at 00:00:00.
2	Leave a name empty, enter more than 12 characters, or repeat a name (also with different capital letters)	The field is marked in red with a message and the game does not start.
3	Roll anything but 6 while all pieces are in the castle	No piece can move; the message says the turn passes, and the next player gets the turn.
4	Roll a 6	The castle pieces and the pieces on the board that can move are highlighted. After the move the same player rolls again.
5	Roll a 6 three times in a row	The third 6 is cancelled: no piece moves and the turn passes to the next player.
6	A roll with a legal move	The player must move one of the highlighted pieces; the turn cannot be skipped. Pieces that cannot move are not highlighted.
7	A piece ends on a plain square with a single opponent piece	The opponent piece is captured and returns to its castle.
8	A piece ends on a start square or a protection square (star) with an opponent	No capture: both pieces stay.
9	A piece reaches its arrow	It turns into its own coloured home path; other colours never enter it.
10	A roll larger than the steps left to the finish	That piece is not highlighted; the finish needs the exact number.
11	A player finishes all four pieces	The player gets the next place in the ranking and takes no more turns.
12	Only one player has pieces left	The game ends and the results screen shows all places and the duration.
13	Main Menu during a game, then "Leave Game"	The game ends without results and the Main Menu opens. "Keep Playing" returns to the game unchanged.

6. How we tested the system

6.1 Automated tests

The project has **380 automated JUnit 5 tests**; on the `main` branch all of them pass (380 passed, 0 failed, 0 skipped; run with `test.bat` / `test.sh`). Every test name carries the SRS requirement it verifies.

Package	Tests	What they check
Model	287	Setup validation, Easy board and protection squares, dice and turn order, Rule of 6, move engine, capture and protection, home path and exact finish, ranking, game clock, full games.
View	73	Main Menu and setup screen, board drawing and scaling, legal-move highlighting, square-by-square animation, screen navigation.
Controller	16	Navigation between screens and the GameController with the real screens and model, including a complete game to the results screen.
Architecture	4	MVC dependency rules: the Model has no Swing, View or Controller imports.

6.2 Our testing method

- **Unit tests by the author** for every class (Definition of Done, SDP 5.3.4).
- **Independent tests:** each game rule was tested again by a team member who did not write it (for example T14, T20, T21, T25).
- **Acceptance tests by the Product Owner** for every user story US-1.1 to US-1.5 (T06, T10, T15, T22, T26). The full-game acceptance test plays 120 complete games with the real dice and rules and checks that each one ends with a correct ranking.
- **Fixed dice sequences** make turn and Rule of 6 scenarios repeatable; seeded random numbers make the board and full games repeatable.
- **Fault seeding:** for the engine and turn tests we planted faults in a copy of the code to check that the tests catch them.
- **Code review on GitHub:** every change was made on a feature branch and merged through a pull request after review. Rule classes had a deep review by both other members.
- **Manual checks:** the game was played by hand on Windows 11 (menu, setup errors, a game, leaving a game, results) and the screenshots in section 4 come from the real application.
- **Second computer (T28):** the submission ZIP was also checked on a second physical computer (Windows 11 Home, Java 25) from a folder with Hebrew letters: all the automated tests pass (380/380 on the final ZIP), run.bat starts the game, and the menu, setup, Easy board, dice, moving a piece out of the castle, turn change, clock and the leave-game confirmation all work. The team also played the game by hand on the computers of all three members. The full checklist is in Iteration1/docs/T28_SecondComputer_Checklist.md.

7. Known limitations of Iteration 1

- Only the Easy level can be played; Medium and Hard are visible but disabled until Iteration 2.
- No Double Blocks, special dice, question squares or surprise squares yet (Iteration 2).
- Game history (the course CSV file), Game History screen and administrator functions are planned for Iteration 3.
- On Windows, starting the JAR by its full path from a folder with Hebrew letters can fail; use `run.bat` (section 2.2).

8. GitHub repository

Repository: https://github.com/shafeekseef81-svg/Sharks

The repository name contains the team name (Sharks). The Iteration 1 code is in the folder Iteration1 on the branch `main` (released from iteration-1 in pull request #42).